Listing 11.8 provides a possible generic implementation of this comparison method, including filtering out shops that don’t have all items in stock, checking distances by using an unspecified heuristic method to decide which shop is the best. Figure 11.4 summarizes the method logic in a flow chart.

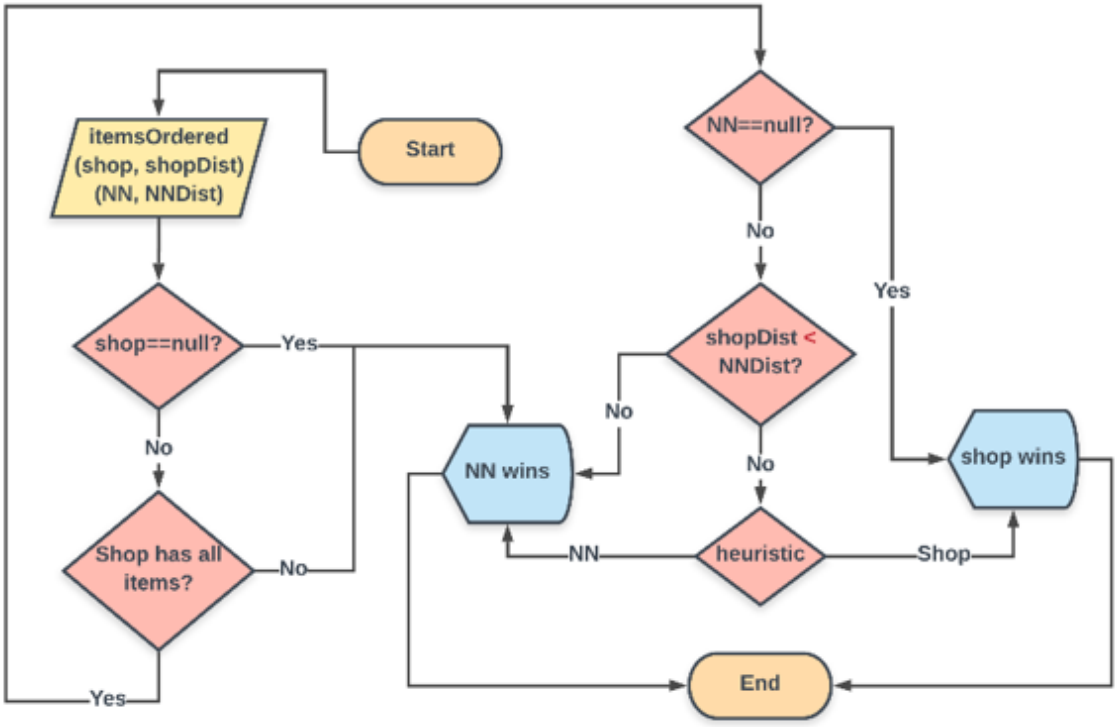


Figure 11.4 Flow chart describing the logic of the compare function defined in listing 11.8.

It’s worth clarifying, once again, that the choice of the heuristic is not connected to any of the data structures we have seen, and vice versa those algorithms doesn’t depend on this function: it’s just a heuristic method that encapsulates all the domain-specific logic, and so it changes from application to application. Depending on how you write it, and how you model the Shop class, you can customize the